FOREIGN POLICY OF THE MUGHALS — ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM
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1) label cautiously -> useful analytical shorthand, not modern ministry
2) Kabul base -> Ghazni node -> Qandahar hinge -> Balkh buffer -> Oxus caution
3) embassies -> elchi/safir -> letters + gifts + status + information
4) four-court field -> Uzbeks / Safavids / Ottomans / Mughals
5) Akbar -> 1577 refusal -> 1585 Kabul -> 1595 Qandahar
6) frontier supervision -> Lahore/Atak watch + passes + local alliances
7) Qandahar -> fort + roads + trade + prestige
8) Jahangir -> cordiality without readiness -> 1622 loss
9) merchants + pilgrimage + Portuguese cartaz = bounded wider context
10) Shah Jahan -> 1638 recovery via Ali Mardan Khan -> Balkh client-buffer attempt
11) 1649-53 -> prepared fort + Lahore supply + winter + siege limits
12) verdict -> India-centred balance strongest; prestige/ambition can outrun sustainability